## ACTIVITY

Do you know when the last Assembly Election was held in your State? Which other elections have taken place in your locality in the last five years? Write down the level of elections (National, Assembly, Panchayat etc.) When were they held? Find out the details of the MLA/MP who got elected from your area.

A. First Past The Post (FPTP)

B. Block Vote(BV)

C. Party Block Vote(PBV)

D. Alternative Vote(AV)

E. Two-Round Systems(TRS)

### A. First Past The Post (FPTP)

The First Past The Post system is the simplest form of plurality/majority system, using single member districts and candidate-centered voting. FTPT systems are found primarily in the UK and those countries historically influenced by Britain. Along with the UK, the other countries are Canada, India and the USA. FPTP is also used by a number of Caribbean countries, Bangladesh, Burma, India, Malaysia, Nepal and small island countries of the South Pacific.

DO YOU KNOW?

FPTP is the simplest form of plurality/majority electoral system. The winning candidate is the one who gains more votes than any other candidate, even if this is not an absolute majority of valid votes. The system uses single-member districts and the voters vote for candidates rather than political parties.

### B. Block Vote (BV)

The Block –Vote is common in countries with weak or non-existent political parties. The Cayman Islands, The Falkland Islands, Guernsey, Kuwait, Laos, Lebanon, the Maldives, Palestine, the Syrian Arab Republic etc use Block Vote electoral systems.

DO YOU KNOW?

Block Vote is a plurality/majority system used in multi-member districts. Electors have as many votes as there are candidates to be selected. The candidates with the highest vote totals win the seats. Usually voters vote for candidates rather than parties and in most systems may use as many, or as few,of their votes as they wish

The Block Vote is often applauded for retaining the voter's ability to vote for individual candidates and allowing for reasonably-organized geographical districts while at the same time, increasing the role of political parties compared with FPTP and strengthening those parties which demonstrate most coherence and organizational structure.

### C. Party Block Vote (PBV)

PBV is simple to use, encourages strong parties and allows for parties to put up mixed slates of candidates in order to facilitate minority representation. It can be used to help to ensure balanced ethnic representation. Dijibouti, Singapore, Senegal, Tunisia use the PBV method.

DO YOU KNOW?

Party-Block Vote is a plurality/majority system using multi- member districts in which voters cast a single party-centered vote for a party of choice, and do not choose between candidates



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